KILNDECK · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

KilnDeck design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-28	Amish Chadha	Kit 1.8 and 1.9 upgrade; open decisions D10 (concept selection), D11 (wind working limit) and D14 (team handling); D12 (storm clamps and tie-downs, STEM S20) and D13 (fits found by the D3 model, STEM S19) made under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23; value engineering updated to USD 2,787
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Register opened; all decisions made under Amish's 2026-10-03 pre-approval

KilnDeck design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/`; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list decisions.

Open decisions

Table 0. Open decisions, proposed, awaiting Amish.

#	To decide	Options	Recommendation	What it affects in the build	Source
D10	Concept carried forward	A, rolling bridge deck (152 of 190); B, wall-top cableway (124 of 190)	A, the current design (18 % ahead); set `concept_chosen: A`	Nothing if A; a new TRL 3 pass for B	KND-OPT-001, KND-DDR-003
D11	Wind working limit	(a) work up to 7 m/s, clamp and tie down above it and before leaving the deck; (b) clamp and tie down at every shift end whatever the weather; (c) no rule, leave it to the kiln	(a) plus (b): the 200 N rim force is used up at about 7.5 m/s, and nor'westers arrive fast	An operating rule in the instructions; no part changes	KND-CAL-001 s15, STM S20
D14	Team-handling limit for pieces carried up the kiln	(a) keep 40 kg (PR-012, decided 2026-10-03); (b) adopt the HSE two-person guide, about 33 kg: five truss modules a side (1,380 mm) and 2.4 m track modules; (c) keep 40 kg and add a rope and pulley for lifting pieces onto the wall top	(b): every piece under 33 kg for about 10 more splice bolts a side and one more track joint a wall; it changes a decided constraint and is a safety trade-off, so it is Amish's call	Truss modules, frame bearers, track modules, drawings and build plan	KND-CAL-001 s16, STM S22

To confirm when parts are bought

These are facts that can only be settled with real parts or a real kiln. None changes a decision; each may change a size.

Table 1. Items to confirm.

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	Survey of the partner kiln: trench width, wall-top width, level and condition, crust level and temperature, feed hole grid	Sets the track gauge (now 6,600 mm), the deck length, the spout reach and the floor temperature figures	KND-CAL-001, section 1
2	Bearing limit of the kiln wall tops from the survey	R8 is met only against the interim 0.20 MPa limit	KND-DDR-002, A2
3	Track wheels: rating of at least 650 kg (D15; was 500 kg), groove widths 24 and 44 mm, axle length for the drive sprocket	Worst wheel load about 447 kg; the inner wheels must float 12 mm	KND-CAL-001, section 9
4	Calcium silicate board: compressive strength at least 0.6 MPa and density near 240 kg/m³	A heel puts about 0.41 MPa on the board; the panel mass assumes this density	KND-CAL-001, section 8
5	Wall thickness and straightness of the SHS bought for the trusses	The truss modules have under 1 kg of margin on the 40 kg limit	KND-CAL-001, section 5
6	Hand wheel rim: 12 holes or room to drill them on a 298 mm circle	The lock pin and the 24 mm stopping step depend on it	KND-CAL-001, section 10
7	Bulk density and lump size of the partner kiln's coal and biomass	Sets the dose per pocket and the grille gap	KND-CAL-001, section 4
8	Silicone grip sleeve to fit a 40 mm square rail, rated to 200 °C	Grip and heat protection on the top rails	BOM line 16
9	Screw ground anchor pull-out in the kiln yard soil, at least 6 kN with a margin	The storm tie-downs (PR-014) hold only if the anchors do	KND-CAL-001 s15, STM S21
10	Price of the storm clamp and tie-down set (BOM line 18, USD 160, estimate)	A quote replaces the estimate	BOM line 18
11	Heat rating of the topcoat paint on parts near the crust	The underside of the trucks and pads sits at crust temperature	BOM line 17

Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 3,500 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 2,787 (USD 713 under the target). The storm clamps and tie-downs (D12) add an estimated USD 160. Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the eight floor panels (USD 544, of which about USD 200 is insulation board), the eight truss modules (USD 432), the track for two 12 m runs (USD 368 plus USD 91 of pads and USD 48 of stops), the travel drive (USD 248) and fasteners, paint and consumables (USD 180).
- The track is about a fifth of the cost and is reused as the fire moves, so a longer working run (the fire moves 6 to 10 m a day) would add about USD 51 per 3 m of both tracks.
- Savings worth trying: aluminium tread sheet in place of steel on the floor panels (lighter, but dearer per panel); reclaimed steel channel for the track; a single chain from the hand wheel direct to the outer-end drive if the line shaft can be shortened after the survey.

Decisions made

Table 2. Decisions made.

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-10-03	TRL 2 review items D1 to D9: deck spans the trench on two wall-top tracks; movable track on the straight sides; hopper carriage beside the deck; hand wheel and line shaft; 1.1 m guardrail with knee rail and toe board; insulated floor; coal and biomass; first co-design candidates (a clean-kiln programme in Bangladesh, then a kiln owners' association in Punjab, Pakistan, not yet approached); budget, pitch and problem unchanged	Amish, pre-approval of 2026-10-03: "start with the first 14 repos from the list of 29 projects. I pre-approve the batch runs along with any recommendations you come up with. I also accept any cost overruns or variations from the assumed scope cost."	KND-DDR-001
2026-10-03	Design for construction, changes C1 to C15: track modules on pads with sliding fishplates, end stops, end trucks with derailment guards, guiding and floating wheels, bolted truss modules, U-frame bearers, insulated floor panels, inward-opening gate, travel drive with lock pin, carriage rail and carriage, hopper grille, rotor with crank over the rail, swing spout, grip sleeves, assembly over the cold zone	Amish, same pre-approval	KND-DDR-002
2026-10-03	Wheels rated at least 500 kg; interim wall bearing limit 0.20 MPa until the survey (conservative; relaxed only by a survey); no shade canopy on the first prototype, with R7 reported as not met in full sun and heat-resistant footwear kept (relaxed only by a canopy wind check and logged floor temperatures); curved kiln ends not served	Amish, same pre-approval	KND-DDR-002, A1 to A4
2026-10-28	D12, storm clamps and tie-downs (STEM check S20 failed: the parked deck would blow along the kiln above about 10 m/s). Options weighed: (a) heavier lock only, no: it cannot hold the track itself, which slides on its pads at 4.8 kN; (b) chain the deck to the track, no: same reason; (c) screw clamps at each wheel plus two tie-down chains a truck to screw ground anchors beyond the walls, yes: about 14.8 kN of hold against 5.8 kN at a 28 m/s gust, set by hand in minutes. Added: BOM line 18 (USD 160, estimate), PR-014, fixed jaws, M16 weld nuts and 18 mm holes on the derailment guards, the guards lowered to 20 mm above the wall top (was 30 mm), lashing lugs on the truck beams	Claude under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23 (fix rule, STANDARDS section 20); Amish can reverse it	KND-CAL-001 s15; KND-STM-001 S20
2026-10-28	D13, fits found when the model was detailed part by part (STEM check S19): bearer cleats and frame bearer end plates reach 160 mm below the bottom chord (to 190 mm above the wall top, was 270 mm) with a column of three M12 under each vertical, so no bolt passes through the chord and the carriage guide rollers run on a clear face; a 40 x 40 x 4 ledger angle on each end frame bearer carries the end floor panels; the two end pillow blocks become UCFL205 flange bearings on the truck beams and the middle three sit on hanger plates beside the splice bearers; a 10 mm fork carrier plate under each wheel position carries the forks and guards, cut back clear of the drive chain at the	Claude under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23; Amish can reverse any of them	KND-CAL-001 s5, s7; `cad/fidelity.json`

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	driven wheels; the boarding step is bolted on (5.6 kg, carried separately); the gate leaf is 15 mm clear of each post (was 5 mm) for the post bolt heads; toe boards stop 30 mm short of the verticals (was flush) clear of the splice bolts; the chain case is 40 mm taller for its flange bearing bolts. No change to what the deck does or to any main dimension; the end truss modules weigh 39.4 and 39.8 kg (were 38.8 and 39.2)		
2026-10-29	D15, wheel rating (STEM check S8, refuted by the independent review: at the 250 kg rated load the worst wheel carries 621 kg, over the 500 kg rating). Options weighed: (a) keep 500 kg wheels and lower the rated load to about 150 kg, no: it changes PR-003 and the scope; (b) specify wheels rated at least 650 kg, yes: same wheel size and grooves, a purchasing change. BOM line 5 spec raised; its price estimate is left at USD 30 and flagged to assess (the USD 713 margin under the target covers a dearer wheel). Also recorded from the same review: the pad pressure at the rated load is 0.207 MPa (3 % over the interim 0.20 MPa; the survey sets the real limit); the proof case of the bridge now includes the carriage (21 MPa); the lock pin hold falls to the pull at a friction of 0.10 (S11 now Plausible); the end stops are the design basis for walking-speed impact only and the track creeps along the wall when struck (S16)	Claude under Amish's standing instruction of 2026-10-23; Amish can reverse it	KND-CAL-001 s9, s10, s17; KND-STM-001 S8, S11, S16
2026-10-03	Appearance model departures: a bolt pattern, a nameplate, a load label and a kiln wall and crust strip drawn for the renders only	Amish, same pre-approval	docs/REVIEW.md, TRL 3 section